KanoonBuddy : Product Requirements Document

Oct 9, 2026 **Review key.** Build draft, 9 October 2026 (data measured 6 October 2026). The review tags have been removed; the tagged version is in the document history. Facts carry one of six labels: **Measured** (checked on your local copy), **Checked** (confirmed on a public page, with the date), **Dataset card** (claimed by the dataset's own pages), **Competitor claim** (from a competitor's website or blog), **Estimate** (worked out from stated inputs, not measured), **Needs verification** (not confirmed, with how to confirm it). Where this PRD and the Tech Stack disagree, the Tech Stack wins.

[To change] Working name only. KanoonBuddy uses Indian Kanoon's brand word and is not the final name — see Naming. No domain, logo, handles or brand spend until the name is decided by [DATE] and a trademark search is complete.

KanoonBuddy is an AI legal research and drafting tool for Indian lawyers and law students, built by LexBharat (registered entity: Needs verification) .
It competes on three things, not on price:

1. Supreme Court depth and verifiability: 78.0% of Supreme Court cases predate 2015, citations are 100.0% complete, and dispositions are concentrated in about ten values that read as final outcomes (all Measured, 6 October 2026), so outcome statistics are strongest here. Whether a competitor already offers outcome statistics is Needs verification (Manupatra offers outcome filtering and judge analytics, and eCourtsIndia says it classifies outcomes; both Competitor claim).
2. Statute lookup with in-force status: section-level (section_number is 98.5% filled), free to serve, and it flags repealed provisions because in_force is 100% filled (Measured, 6 October 2026; Needs verification: see the act_status note in What the audit found). Manupatra already documents in-force status publicly, using red, yellow and blue flags (fully overruled, partly overruled, signed but not yet in force) plus amendment-history footnotes (Competitor claim, 6 October 2026 competitive-analysis pass; Needs verification before public use). Our actual differentiator is narrower: ours is free, section-level and runs at zero marginal cost on our own data, against Manupatra's paid, editorial version (₹14,250 to ₹55,460 a year, with AI billed separately; Competitor claim, Needs verification). Reviewed OKF knowledge notes add the other half: they map old law to new (IPC to BNS, CrPC to BNSS, Evidence Act to BSA), so an answer on Section 377 IPC states the BNS replacement, the gap seen in Prism's answer.
3. Visible usage limits in plain numbers instead of hidden credits, and a free tier that costs almost nothing to run: Act and section lookup and outcome statistics are free payload filters and need no embedding call.

The open-india-law dataset (CC BY 4.0) holds about 15.7 million case records (distinct case_id, not one per case; see What the audit found) and about 22,000 Acts and regulatory instruments, already embedded for semantic search (Measured on your copy).

Version 1 serves only the Supreme Court and acts_india. The Bombay, Telangana and Kerala High Courts are phase 2, added when paying users cover the server cost (Needs verification: which High Courts first; see Launch courts).

KanoonBuddy is cheaper than Prism only at the Student tier.
At Pro it is priced at parity, so it must win on the features above.

Prism teardown

Prism is Indian Kanoon's AI suite. It launched on 5 December 2025 as 8 tools on top of Indian Kanoon's database, which its own pages describe as 4+ crore (40M+) documents. Its main promise is answers grounded in real judgments, so citations are not invented. Source: Prism's own pages, so these are claims, not measured by us. Roughly 2.8 crore of that is orders and judgments, because Indian Kanoon counts procedural orders as separate documents, and the remainder is statutory instruments, bills, rules, notifications and debates (Competitor claim, Needs verification). Our own case_id is not one per case either (Rajasthan has 1,056,767 case_id against 308,342 case_number; Measured, 6 October 2026), so document counts are not comparable across products and we should never compete on this number.

Prism tool	What it does	KanoonBuddy equivalent
Know Your Kanoon	Legal research chatbot. Answers a legal question with citations from the Indian Kanoon database.	Research chat
Talk with IK-doc	Ask questions about any single Indian Kanoon judgment. Documents over 50k words have limited support.	Talk with a single judgment
DocHub (DocGen Hub)	Draft from 80+ Indian legal templates. Review your own drafts (Standard, Risk, Negotiation analysis). Compare drafts side by side.	Drafting, review and compare

Prism tool	What it does	KanoonBuddy equivalent
Upload and Chat	Upload your own document and ask clause-level questions. Costs fewer credits if the document is already on Indian Kanoon.	Upload and chat
CasePredictAI	Predicts likely case outcome and suggests strategies with reasoning.	Outcome statistics (descriptive, not prediction)
Counter Argument Generator	Builds rebuttals, procedural defences and precedents against an argument.	Counter arguments (P2)
Legal Sandbox: Moot Court Simulation	Practice moot court in an interactive setting.	Moot court (P2)
Legal Sandbox: Study Buddy	Exam and LLM entrance preparation, lesson plans.	Study buddy (P2)

Prism says it is information and education only, not legal advice. One independent review (Bharat.Law, itself a competitor) flags citation reliability concerns at the free tier and no court tracking. That review's claim needs verification by testing Prism yourself.

A hands-on test on 6 October 2026 (10 prompts across 5 legal-AI platforms, one run each) found that Prism answered all 4 prompts it was given correctly, with full chronological case chains and a tick or warning verification mark on each citation. This was the strongest actual result of any product in that run. Its one flagged gap was currency, not a fabricated citation: it said Section 377 IPC "remains active" without noting the BNS replacement from 1 July 2024. Our knowledge notes are built to close exactly this gap. This is one-run, small-sample evidence, not a benchmark (Competitor claim; Needs verification before public use).

Prism pricing and comparison

Prism is a paid add-on to a free search engine. All 8 tools are open on every plan; plans differ in how many credits you get. Prices below are from Prism's pricing page (a claim).

Prism plan	Prism price (+18% GST)	What you get	Closest KanoonBuddy plan	Price comparison
Free	₹0	A few credits, 25 court copy downloads a month, 2 query alerts	Free	Both ₹0
Premium	₹500 / ₹1,500 / ₹2,700 / ₹5,000	20x Free credits a month, 500 MB, 250 court copies a month, 25 alerts	Pro, ₹499 a month	Monthly: ₹499 vs ₹500, about equal. Yearly with 2 months free: ₹4,990 vs ₹5,000, about equal. KanoonBuddy Pro is not cheaper than Prism Premium
Premium (entry)	₹500	Same as above	Student, ₹199 a month	₹301 a month lower, about 60% less
Pro	₹1,500 / ₹4,500 / ₹8,000 / ₹15,000	100x Free credits a month, 2 GB, 1,000 court copies, 100 alerts	None yet. Chambers is ₹299 per user a month	No direct match; KanoonBuddy has no plan with equal limits yet

The four price points per plan are unlabelled on the page. I read them as 1, 3, 6 and 12 months because the 12-month Pro price matches the ₹15,000 a year that reviewers quote. **Needs verification:** open the pricing page and click each billing period. Whether KanoonBuddy prices include GST is also undecided.

Credits are usage-based, reset monthly, and the number of credits per action is not published. A 1-year recharge also gets merchandise. Prism's cost shape is the same as any LLM product: usage inside a subscription. KanoonBuddy's answer is visible limits in plain numbers.

What is public about Prism's LLM and stack

Indian Kanoon has not said publicly which LLM powers Prism, and I found it on no page I could open. Anyone who says "it uses GPT" or "it uses Gemini" is guessing.

Public (Prism's own pages)

- It uses task-specific AI agents per tool, not one general chatbot.

- It is built on Indian Kanoon's own document database. Indian Kanoon's blog says context is what stops the LLM from hallucinating citations.
- Documents over 50k words are only partly supported (Talk with IK-doc).
- It supports organisation accounts and is offered to law schools (NLSIU, JGU, Lawctopus), per Indian Kanoon's own post.

Not public

- The LLM vendor or model name.
- The search and retrieval stack, embeddings and vector database.
- The frontend and backend framework.

How to find out. *(1) Attend the JGU or NLSIU sessions on Prism's technical architecture (JGU's ran 14 June 2026). (2) Ask Indian Kanoon through its feedback form. (3) Test it with Hindi and long-document questions and watch speed and refusals; this gives clues, not proof. None of this blocks KanoonBuddy: the model is a swappable part and the value is in the data and retrieval around it.*

Other competitors

Prism is not the only option. Prices below are from third-party pages, several of them competitors' own blogs, so every price needs verification against the vendor's own site or a sales call.

Competitor	What it is	Public price	Source and caveat
SCC Online	Publisher-grade case law database with headnotes; AI features are new	About ₹18,999 a year for a print-plus-digital bundle; individual ₹20,000 to ₹30,000 and firms ₹60,000 to ₹2,00,000+ a year	Bharat.Law and LawCentral blogs (both competitors). Needs verification
Manupatra	25-year incumbent research suite with an AI product	No public rate card. LawCentral's blog claims ₹15,000 to ₹25,000 a year for individuals	Bharat.Law says demo-based. Needs verification
CaseMine (AMICUS AI)	AI case law research and drafting	USD 499 a year (Essential); USD 1,499.99 a year (AI Premium). Upload cap of 100 MB	Bharat.Law. Needs verification

Competitor	What it is	Public price	Source and caveat
Lexlegis.ai	AI legal research	Not found in any page I could open	Needs verification: check its website or request a demo

Competitor	What it is	Public price	Source and caveat
Bharat.Law	AI research with live court tracking	Free tier; paid plans not listed	Its own page, which claims 15,000+ courts tracked. Needs verification. Its published design retrieves citations from its own database rather than letting the model generate them, links each claim at paragraph level, and says "not found" rather than guessing (it calls this the "Honest Uncertainty Protocol"). That is the closest public match to this PRD's own citation-verifier plan and is worth modelling the verifier pipeline on (Competitor claim: unverified vendor marketing; Needs verification). The 6 October 2026 hands-on test covered a different product also called "BharatLaw" with an assistant named Nyal, likely a different company (bharatlaw.ai, not bharat.law, Bharat Technologies Inc.). That test's result, a six-question clarifying loop that never produced an answer, must not be attributed to this row's product

Competitor	What it is	Public price	Source and caveat
LawCentral AI	10 free AI tools plus paid plans	₹1,000 a month (Starter); ₹4,900 a month (Pro); ₹3,500 per seat a month, minimum 2 seats (Team)	LawCentral's own page
KanoonGPT	Bare Acts with AI chat; a hands-on test on 6 October 2026 (one run per prompt) found it answering case-law questions directly (Section 138 NI Act, the Karnataka hijab case, Navtej Singh Johar), not deferring them. Two answers had high-severity errors delivered with no hedging: it reversed a real statutory holding (said a 2015 amendment "ratified" a rule that it actually overrode) and misnamed a judge in a Supreme Court split verdict (Competitor claim, single-sample evidence). Needs re-verification before any public claim about what KanoonGPT covers	₹129 for 3 days, then ₹1,299 a month; ₹7,499 a year	KanoonGPT's own page
Jhana.ai	LLM research over Indian law	Not stated	Reported $1.6M seed funding (eCourts India blog)
NyayGuru and other free tools	Free-tier AI assistants used by students and junior advocates	Free	iPleaders guide. Pricing needs verification

Competitor	What it is	Public price	Source and caveat
Vaquill	Sells a full legal AI product (contract drafting and review, redlining, compliance, vendor management, legal research with 8M+ US opinions in-product), publishes the dataset we depend on, and sells API and bulk data access	Not stated	Dataset card and Vaquill's own pages, checked 1 October 2026 (Competitor claim)

Takeaway: the paid market runs from ₹1,000 a month up to ₹30,000 a year and above, and free tools set the floor. KanoonBuddy's ₹199 and ₹499 sit at the low end of paid tools, which fits students and small chambers.

Data foundation

KanoonBuddy is built on the open-india-law dataset from Vaquill AI, a static snapshot (v2026.08) of official government sources. It is on your SSD, and all 32,518,048 vectors are loaded in your local Qdrant. Case counts, chunk counts, fill rates and vector totals below are **measured** on your copy (from your notes, re-measured on 6 October 2026; see What the audit found). The licence terms, the removal of personal details and the tribunal list are **dataset card** claims.

Item	What your copy holds	At launch
Supreme Court	37,014 cases	Live
High Courts	All 25 High Courts. With the Supreme Court, 15,693,540 cases in 26 judgment files, split into about 32.6M chunks, of which about 31.4M are embedded for meaning-based search (Measured; the gap is covered in Text without vectors)	Not at launch. Phase 2: Bombay, Telangana and Kerala, added when paying users cover the server cost (Needs verification: decide after the 20 interviews; count vectors per court in Qdrant first). Held: the other 22 High Courts
District and trial courts	Not included	Not held

Item	What your copy holds	At launch
Tribunals	None in our 75 files (Measured). 813,168 tribunal and regulator matters across 15 forums (CAT, CESTAT, ITAT, DRT, NCLT, NGT, SAT and others) are published free as PDFs at tribunals.vaquill.ai under CC BY 4.0, with no text layer, so the cost is OCR and extraction, not licensing. About 348,516 are reasoned decisions (Vaquill's estimate from 150-document samples per forum). Competitor claim for these figures	Not held
Regulators	12	Live, inside acts_india
Legislation	10,112 Acts and 12,152 regulatory instruments (such as RBI and SEBI), stored as 1,098,269 chunk rows in parquet and 1,098,577 points in Qdrant (the 308 difference is unexplained; Needs verification). Rows are chunks, but section_number is filled on 98.5% of the legislation rows (Measured, 6 October 2026)	Live (acts_india)
Embeddings	Voyage AI voyage-4, 1024 dimensions, cosine distance. 3 Qdrant collections: legal_corpus_v1 (19,595,718 points), legal_corpus_v2 (11,823,753), acts_india (1,098,577)	Only the Supreme Court and acts_india are served, from one new launch collection; the rest is held
Files and size	75 parquet files (26 judgment, 37 legislation, 12 regulation), about 50 GB of text. About 440 GB of vectors on disk; the full snapshot is 463.6 GB	Whole dataset held. Launch scope (Supreme Court and acts_india) is about 42 to 55 GB of vectors ((2 to 3M Supreme Court points + 1.1M acts_india points) × about 13.5 KB; Estimate; the Supreme Court point count is not yet measured; see Fixed infrastructure cost)

Item	What your copy holds	At launch
Licence	Data: CC BY 4.0, credit required. Code: Apache-2.0. Underlying legal text: government work under the Copyright Act, section 52(1)(q)	Applies to everything held

What this means for KanoonBuddy

- **Rights are safer, but the credit link differs by content type.** Commercial use is allowed if you give credit. Show "Data: Open India Law by Vaquill AI, CC BY 4.0". Link each judgment through its pdf_url (a Cloudflare R2 link) and each Act through its source_url. Judgments have no source_url. Have a lawyer confirm this for your product.
- **Voyage is needed only for meaning-based search.** The stored vectors were made with voyage-4, so each semantic question must be embedded with the same model, which is a paid API call. But all 67 payload fields can be read and filtered without any embedding. Act lookup by section number, outcome counts, and filters by court, year and disposition cost nothing per query. Switching model means re-embedding all 32.5M vectors.
- **Coverage is partial.** There are 15.7M cases plus 1.1M legislation chunks, with no tribunals and no district courts. Do not claim more coverage than you have.
- **The statute edge is real. section_number is filled on 98.5% of legislation rows and in_force on 100% (Measured, 6 October 2026), so section lookup and in-force flags work on our own data at zero per-query cost, and an answer can quote the right provision next to a case. Needs verification: see the act_status note in What the audit found**.
- **Outcome data is strongest for the Supreme Court. 98.8% of cases record a disposition overall, but Supreme Court dispositions are concentrated in about ten values that read as final outcomes, while the 577-value cleaning problem belongs to the High Courts (Measured, 6 October 2026)**.
- **The data is frozen.** It is a point-in-time snapshot, not current law. Show a "data as of" date in the app and plan how you will refresh it.
- **Personal details are already removed**, according to the dataset card (victim names, phone numbers, account numbers).

What the audit found

Every figure below is Measured on 6 October 2026 with DuckDB across all 75 parquet files, unless marked otherwise.

Item	Finding
Snapshot on disk	v2026.08. Vaquill has published v2026.08.1, which we do not hold. Its headline change is source_url pointing at the publisher's page on 83.3% of rows (Competitor claim)
Totals	32,572,660 chunks; 15,693,540 distinct case_id; 1,098,269 legislation rows; 22,264 acts. These match the earlier figures, except that Qdrant's acts_india holds 1,098,577 points against 1,098,269 parquet rows. The 308 difference is unexplained (Needs verification)
Judgments against the dataset card	The card claims 12,848,644 judgments, and its per-court table sums to exactly that. The disk holds 15,693,540 distinct case_id, which is 22% more (Dataset card against Measured)
case_id is not one per case	Rajasthan has 1,056,767 case_id against 308,342 distinct case_number; Patna has 1,614,939 against 504,632. So 15.7M counts case records, and the true number of cases is lower and not yet measured (Needs verification: count distinct case_number per court)
Checksums	SHA256SUMS.json and totals.json each describe one file (Kerala). 74 of 75 files have no published checksum
Law Commission reports	Present: 77,080 rows, 558 instruments
Legislation status	act_status: in force 59,596, repealed 14,604, spent 284 rows (848, 710 and 10 by distinct act). Needs verification: these 74,484 rows and 1,568 acts are far fewer than the 1,098,269 rows and 22,264 acts, so confirm what in_force means for the rest before launching the in-force flag. Working decision: show the flag only on acts whose act_status is filled, and label every other Act result "in-force status not checked" until that check is done

Coverage is shallower than the court list suggests

The dataset card's "Earliest" column is the single oldest document in a court, not where its coverage begins. The table shows the share of each court's cases dated before 2015 (Measured, 6 October 2026), deepest first, beside the earliest year the card claims (Dataset card).

Court	Cases before 2015	Card's earliest year
Supreme Court	78.0%	1950
Telangana	45.4%	1963
Bombay	45.0%	1953
Kerala	39.9%	1950
Patna	33.0%	1967
Himachal Pradesh	31.7%	not in the audit summary
Punjab and Haryana	30.1%	not in the audit summary
Gujarat	29.6%	not in the audit summary
Chhattisgarh	26.4%	not in the audit summary
Gauhati	22.2%	not in the audit summary
Rajasthan	17.6%	not in the audit summary
Delhi	15.8%	1960
Karnataka	12.9%	not in the audit summary
Madras	7.4%	1997
Orissa	1.0%	1992
Jammu and Kashmir	0.9%	not in the audit summary
Allahabad	0.0%	1992
Andhra Pradesh	0.0%	1995
Calcutta	0.0%	1960

Calcutta is advertised as 1960 to 2025 (Dataset card) yet has zero cases before 2015, and Delhi has one case in 1960 and six in 1997 (Measured). Seven High Courts are not in the audit summary I was given (Needs verification).

Consequence: for historical research our corpus is a Supreme Court archive with a thin High Court layer, and any marketing claim of "all 25 High Courts since 1950" would be false.

Launch courts. The launch set is the Supreme Court and acts_india only (decision). The depth-optimal High Court set for phase 2 is Bombay, Telangana and Kerala (45.0%, 45.4% and 39.9% of cases before 2015), because Delhi (15.8%) and Madras (7.4%) are the two shallowest of the four courts planned earlier. The counter-argument is that Delhi High Court carries disproportionate commercial, constitutional, tax and IP work, so practical relevance may outweigh archive depth, and the validation interviews should settle it. Working decision: the first High Courts added in phase 2 are chosen after the interviews, and Delhi is the alternative to Bombay, Telangana and Kerala (Needs verification). Needs verification: decide after the 20 interviews; also count vectors per court in Qdrant for the server sizing.

Data quality, measured on your copy

Field	Fill rate	Problem
source_url, judgments	0.0%	Use pdf_url instead
source_url, legislation	100%	Legislation also has mirror_url
citation, Supreme Court	100.0%	No problem. The verifier can check real citation strings such as "[1979] 3 S.C.R. 453" (Measured, 6 October 2026)
citation, all 25 High Courts	0.0%	The verifier must fall back to record existence and quoted text (Measured, 6 October 2026)
disposition (how the case was decided)	98.8%	577 different values, a High Court problem (the Supreme Court is concentrated in about ten values: Appeal(s) allowed 13,913, Dismissed 13,800, Disposed off 4,724, Case Partly allowed 1,825, Case Allowed 733, out of 37,014 cases; Measured, 6 October 2026), such as "ALLOWED" and "Allowed/Partly Allowed on merits"; needs cleaning into a short list
judges	32.7%	Sampled values were extraction garbage, such as "another" and "apply for bail"
petitioner and respondent	99.9%	Often counsel names or sentence fragments, not party names

Field	Fill rate	Problem
section_number, legislation	98.5%	No problem. Section lookup works directly on our own data (Measured, 6 October 2026)
in_force, legislation	100%	No problem as a field, with act_status in force, repealed or spent (Measured, 6 October 2026). Needs verification: see the act_status note in What the audit found

These figures were re-measured on 6 October 2026 with DuckDB over all 75 parquet files (see What the audit found).

Text without vectors

Your notes report about 32,572,660 judgment chunks in the parquet files but about 31,419,471 judgment vectors in Qdrant (19,595,718 in legal_corpus_v1 plus 11,823,753 in legal_corpus_v2). If both counts are right, about 1,153,189 chunks (about 3.5%) exist as text that meaning-based search cannot reach. That reading holds only if the 32,572,660 total leaves out legislation. If the total includes the 1,098,269 legislation rows, judgment chunks are about 31,474,391 (32,572,660 − 1,098,269) and the gap is about 55,000 (31,474,391 − 31,419,471 = 54,920, or 0.2%). Needs verification: count rows per judgment file versus points per collection.

Needs verification: count the rows in each of the 26 judgment parquet files, count the points per collection, and list which courts and years are short. Fix: embed the missing chunks with voyage-4 (a one-time Voyage cost, needs verification) or leave those courts out of the launch. Vaquill's India page says "12.8M+ Court judgments", its GitHub says 32.5M judgment chunks (both Competitor claim), and our copy measures 15,693,540 distinct cases and about 32.57M chunks (Measured). Cases and chunks are being reported interchangeably across their pages. The Week 1 to 2 audit reconciles all three figures, and this is part of question (b) for Vaquill.

Legislation: our snapshot or the Vaquill API

Judgments are not available through any Vaquill API. Its India API is legislation only, and case-law search, citation resolution and docket data are not exposed as public API endpoints for India at any price (Competitor claim: Vaquill's own pages, checked 1 October 2026). The local corpus is therefore the only route to judgments short of a data-licensing contract. For legislation, the local snapshot works on its own and the API is an optional breadth upgrade:

	Our local snapshot	Vaquill API
Instruments covered	10,112 Acts and 12,152 regulator instruments, 22,264 in all (Measured)	64,179 acts: 19,965 central, 32,268 state and UT, 11,946 regulator rules (Competitor claim)
Section-level retrieval	Yes, by section_number, filled on 98.5% of legislation rows (Measured, 6 October 2026)	Yes. 745,970 individually retrievable sections (Competitor claim)
Amendment history	In-force status only: in_force is filled on 100% of rows, with act_status in force, repealed or spent (Measured, 6 October 2026). Full amendment history is not confirmed (Needs verification)	Yes, with corresponding-provisions mapping (Competitor claim)
Freshness	Frozen at v2026.08 (Dataset card)	Needs verification: freshness of the API itself is not stated on the pages read. Vaquill advertises a daily full-corpus sync under data licensing; price not published (Competitor claim)
Cost per query	Free: payload filter	1 credit = US$0.01. Coverage and filters free; list and status 1 credit; search 2; section retrieval 1 to 3; full amendment history 5. Free signup gives 5 queries a day; verified nonprofit legal aid and public interest organisations get the full API free (Competitor claim)

Decision: serve legislation from our own data at zero per-query cost. The Vaquill API (64,179 acts against our 22,264) is worth pricing later as a breadth upgrade, not a dependency. If we ever use it, populate and refresh our own store and keep API calls off the per-query path. A search costs 2 credits, about ₹1.76 at ₹88 per US$ (Estimate). Against the 3,000 monthly visits assumed in the MAU path, that is about ₹2,600 a month if half the visits run one search and about ₹5,300 if every visit does (3,000 × ₹1.76), so the free tier would become our largest variable cost at exactly the traffic we are trying to grow.

Caveat, only if we use the API. This depends on whether the API licence permits caching responses and serving them to end users, including on public search-indexed pages. The dataset is CC BY 4.0, but API terms are usually separate. Needs verification: this is question (a) in the Vaquill email in the Week 1 to 2 roadmap.

Problem, goals and users

Indian lawyers and students need fast, trustworthy legal research, and many AI tools are either expensive or unreliable on citations. KanoonBuddy aims to give fast answers with checked citations at a low price.

Goals

1. Deliver the core tools people use most: research chat, Act and section lookup, and upload and chat. Drafting follows as a P1 tool.
2. Every case or Act KanoonBuddy cites is a real record in the dataset, and it flags anything it cannot verify.
3. Keep the price low enough for students and small chambers, with visible usage limits.
4. Offer outcome statistics from real decisions.

Non-goals for v1

- Court tracking, e-filing, or a full practice-management suite.
- Giving legal advice. KanoonBuddy is an information tool.

Target users

User	Need	Why they would switch
Law students	Case digests, moot prep, exam prep	Low price, student plan
Junior advocates, small chambers	Fast research and first drafts	Low price, clear limits
Solo practitioners in district courts	Drafting, quick precedent lookup. v1 has no High Court or district-court judgments, so their value at launch is statute lookup, Supreme Court precedent and drafting	Simple interface, Hindi support

MVP scope

The MVP is research chat, Act and section lookup, upload and chat (document chat), and citation checking. Upload and chat ships in v1. Drafting and outcome statistics follow within 3 months of launch.

Feature	Priority	Cost to run	Notes
Research chat with citations	P0	Paid: 1 Voyage embedding call and 1 re-rank call; 2 to 3 LLM calls (query rewrite, a conversation summary refresh every few turns, and the answer); and Jev checks (scope, filters and safety; the gate on each of up to 10 passages; the claim-support check on each cited sentence). The Jev checks run in parallel and use about 8,000 input tokens in total, about ₹0.03 per answer (Estimate). Voyage costs about ₹0.05 per answer (re-rank of 50 passages × ~500 tokens = 25,000 tokens × US$0.02 per million = US$0.0005, about ₹0.044 at ₹88; Estimate). Needs verification: whether Voyage's 200M free tokens are a one-time grant or monthly (check Voyage's pricing page). A cache hit costs nothing	Answer plus links to real judgments; refuses when nothing relevant is found

Feature	Priority	Cost to run	Notes
Courts searchable at launch	P0	Free: already embedded, no new cost	Supreme Court and acts_india only. The Bombay, Telangana and Kerala High Courts are phase 2, added when paying users cover the server cost (Needs verification: decide after the 20 interviews; count vectors per court in Qdrant first)
Citation verifier	P0	Free payload lookups for checks 1 to 3, plus the support check on each cited sentence (Jev, or Gemini in upload chats; inside the ₹0.03 per answer Jev figure; Estimate)	Four checks on each citation. 1. The source was retrieved for this question. 2. The record exists in the launch collection. 3. Quoted words match exactly. 4. Jev or Gemini rates support: tick = supports, warning = partly, does not support = removed and logged. See "What Verified means"

Feature	Priority	Cost to run	Notes
Act and section lookup	P0	Free: payload filter, no embedding	Works directly on our own data at zero per-query cost: section_number is filled on 98.5% of legislation rows and in_force on 100% (Measured, 6 October 2026), so results can show in-force status and flag repealed provisions. Manupatra already documents in-force flags in a paid, editorial version (Competitor claim; Needs verification), so our difference is that this is free, section-level and zero marginal cost on our own data. The Vaquill API (64,179 acts against our 22,264; Competitor claim) is an optional breadth upgrade, not a dependency; see Legislation: our snapshot or the Vaquill API

Feature	Priority	Cost to run	Notes
Decision layer (Jev)	P0	Paid: about ₹0.03 per answer (Estimate: about 8,000 input tokens across all checks)	Scope, filters and safety checks; the answer-or-refuse gate on each of up to 10 passages; and the claim-support check on each cited sentence. They run in parallel. Easy-or-hard routing is switched OFF at launch: every question goes to its plan's default model, and routing turns on once the stronger model is chosen. Upload text never goes to Jev: in upload chats the support check and any other decision on upload text use Gemini (paid tier) until TypeSafe confirms its terms in writing. Early access, so Gemini is also the fallback. Access and written data terms are Needs verification

Feature	Priority	Cost to run	Notes
Knowledge notes (OKF)	P0	Free to serve; reviewer time	Markdown notes that map old law to new: IPC to BNS, CrPC to BNSS, Evidence Act to BSA. Only reviewed notes reach live answers. The advocate reviews legal content (law maps, leading cases, limitation periods). The founder reviews coverage rules, terms and disposition labels. A note never counts as a citation by itself. This closes the Section 377 currency gap seen in Prism's answer (Competitor claim)
Answer cache	P0	Free: Redis on the same server	Verified answers are kept for 7 days (Estimate). Uploads are never cached
Invented-citation log	P0	Free: database table	Records all four failure reasons: not retrieved, record missing, quote not found, claim not supported. Metric: share of answers with at least one removed citation. Target: under 0.5% (Estimate; confirm on the 50-question test)
Source credit and data-as-of date	P0	Free	Required by CC BY 4.0. Link judgments through pdf_url and Acts through source_url

Feature	Priority	Cost to run	Notes
Upload and chat	P0. Ships in v1, after the three public-launch conditions in Notes	Paid: LLM calls on the Gemini paid tier, OCR for scans, and Voyage voyage-4 to embed the upload into user_documents. Recommendation: voyage-4, not a local model. It matches the main search, uses the same adapter and adds no memory load on the 16 GB server. Privacy trade-off: upload chunks go to Voyage outside India, so written no-training and retention terms are needed first (Needs verification). If Voyage will not give them, switch to a local model, at the cost of memory pressure and a second index	PDF and Word upload, clause-level questions. Ships in v1. Before public launch it needs three things: the advocate's written opinion on privilege and DPDP roles, Voyage's written no-training and retention terms, and the upload rules in the Tech Stack (the limits are Needs verification). Upload text never goes to Jev. In upload chats the claim-support check and any other decision that involves upload text use Gemini (paid tier) until TypeSafe confirms its terms in writing. The three free verifier checks still run
Usage meter	P0	Free: database counter	Show users exactly what each action costs
Outcome statistics	P1	Free per query: payload filter and count. One-time Jev pass to clean the Supreme Court values first. High Court values wait for phase 2 and their own 50-judgment check (Needs verification of size)	Counts of how cases were decided by court, year and issue, from the disposition field (98.8% filled, measured). Supreme Court statistics unblock on the 50-judgment Supreme Court check; High Court statistics wait for their own 50

Feature	Priority	Cost to run	Notes
Drafting from templates	P1	Paid: LLM call	Start with 20 templates (notices, agreements, bail applications) and grow from there
Review and compare drafts	P1	Paid: LLM call	Risk review and side-by-side compare
Talk with a single judgment	P1	Free to fetch the judgment by case_id; paid LLM call to answer	Summary, issues, ratio. Long judgments need chunking
Hindi and regional languages	P1	Paid: same calls as research chat	Stays P1; it moves to P0 if the 20 interviews show strong demand. Test how voyage-4 handles Hindi questions before you promise it. BM25 keyword search needs a Hindi-aware tokenizer, and Gemini Hindi answers need testing (all Needs verification)
Counter arguments	P2	Paid: embedding + LLM call	After research chat is solid
Case outcome prediction	P2	Paid: embedding + LLM call	Outcome statistics cover most of the need. Ship prediction only with clear warnings, or skip
Moot court and study buddy	P2	Paid: LLM call	Low cost, good for student growth

Feature	Priority	Cost to run	Notes
Tribunal and regulator search	Later	Not applicable	Our copy has no tribunal files (Measured). The matters are published free as PDFs with no text layer, so the cost is OCR and extraction, not licensing, which makes tribunals a post-launch expansion. Regulator instruments are inside the legislation collection

Priority key: P0 = needed to launch, P1 = within 3 months of launch, P2 = later.

What "Verified" means

The verified badge is the core trust claim, so it states only what the check can prove. The first three checks are free payload lookups. The fourth is a Jev call (a Gemini call in upload chats).

1. The source was retrieved for this question.
2. The record exists in the launch collection.
3. Quoted words match exactly.
4. Jev or Gemini rates support: tick = supports, warning = partly, does not support = removed and logged.

The badge means	The badge does not mean
The cited case or Act section exists as a record in the dataset (matched by its record ID).	The case is good law. It may have been overruled, distinguished or reversed on appeal.
Words shown in quotation marks appear in that record's text.	The quoted passage is the holding, or the AI's summary of it is right.
The link goes to the record's pdf_url (judgments) or source_url (Acts).	The link works today, or the text is current law. The data is a snapshot (v2026.08).

The badge means	The badge does not mean
If the record has a citation field, it is shown exactly as stored, labelled "as recorded in the dataset".	The citation string (for example an SCC or AIR reference) is correct or complete. It is filled on 100.0% of Supreme Court chunks and 0.0% of High Court chunks (Measured, 6 October 2026), so High Court answers will show none and the badge falls back to record existence and quoted text.
The cited passage was retrieved for this question, so the AI cannot cite a record it never saw.	Other relevant cases were not missed.
Jev rates the passage as supporting the sentence it is cited for. A tick means it supports. A warning mark means it supports only partly.	A lawyer reviewed the point. Jev is a model check and can be wrong.

Suggested badge wording: "Record found in dataset" with the data-as-of date, and a short link to this definition. A tick means the passage supports the sentence. A warning mark means it supports it only partly. Anything that fails the check is removed or marked "Not verified".

Recommendation: show the verification check per citation, with a tick or warning mark next to each one, rather than a single badge covering the whole answer. This matches Prism's pattern, and it is the UI pattern the 6 October 2026 hands-on test found users could actually act on (Competitor claim, single-sample evidence; Needs verification in the user interviews).

Failure and edge states

Situation	What the user sees	What it costs
No relevant results	"No matching judgments found in our dataset (data as of the snapshot date)." Suggestions to rephrase or use Act lookup. No written answer is generated, so nothing is invented.	One search call, no LLM call

Situation	What the user sees	What it costs
Voyage API is down	A notice that meaning-based search is unavailable. Act lookup, outcome statistics and keyword search still work and are labelled "keyword results only". A retry button.	No Voyage call
A judgment is longer than the model can read	"This judgment is too long to read in full. Answering from the most relevant parts." The parts used are listed, and the user can ask about a page range.	Needs verification: measure the longest judgments and the chosen model's limit in the audit
An upload is an unreadable scan	"We could not read this file. Try a clearer scan or paste the text." Nothing is guessed. The usage meter is not charged.	OCR attempt only. The quality threshold needs verification
The dataset has no coverage of the question	"Version 1 covers Supreme Court judgments and central and state Acts and regulations. It does not include High Courts, district courts, tribunals, or judgments after the snapshot date." It points to the official court site.	No LLM call if detected early. Detection method needs verification
The LLM provider fails or times out	The retrieved sources are shown with links but no written answer, and the user can retry.	Retrieval cost only
The verifier rejects a cited authority	The answer is shown with that citation removed and a note saying one authority could not be verified. The failure is written to the invented-citation log.	Free

Speed and reliability targets

These targets come from the Tech Stack. Each is an Estimate until it is measured on the 50-question test in build step 2.

Measure	Target	Label
First word of an answer	Under 3 seconds	Estimate
Full answer	Under 20 seconds	Estimate
Search plus re-rank	Under 800 ms	Estimate
Each Jev decision	Under 800 ms (the vendor claims 70 to 500 ms)	Estimate; vendor figure is a Competitor claim
Act and section lookup	Under 500 ms	Estimate
Text-PDF upload ready to ask about	Under 60 seconds	Estimate
Scanned-PDF upload ready to ask about	Under 5 minutes	Estimate
API availability	99.5% a month (about 3.6 hours of downtime)	Estimate; one server, no failover

Proposed tech stack

This is the decided stack, from the Tech Stack document of 6 October 2026. One server runs everything in Docker Compose. Search runs on a new Qdrant collection built from the data you already have. The AI model stays swappable through one gateway, and you spend money only on the steps that need a strong model.

Layer	Choice	Why
Frontend	Next.js + Tailwind	One codebase for web and mobile-friendly UI; fast to build
Backend	Python FastAPI	Best library support for AI and document work

Layer	Choice	Why
Vector search	Qdrant, self-hosted. One new launch collection, kanoon_v1 (Supreme Court and acts_india), with meaning vectors and keyword vectors. A second collection, user_documents, holds uploads	The dataset ships as Qdrant snapshots. Build step 1 tests whether adding a header and re-embedding gives better search (Needs verification). Scalar quantization keeps memory down
Query embeddings	Voyage AI voyage-4, for meaning-based search only	Any other model cannot search these vectors. Filter-only queries need no embedding. US$0.06 per million tokens, first 200M free (Checked)
Re-ranker	Voyage rerank-2.5-lite (US$0.02 per million tokens, first 200M free; Checked), with a bge-reranker as backup	Keeps the best 10 of the top 50 passages, in order, before the AI reads them. Search plus re-rank under 800 ms (Estimate)
Filters	Qdrant payload filters (court, year, disposition, Act, section)	Free per query; all 67 payload fields are readable
Keyword search	Qdrant BM25 sparse vectors in the same collection, built with fastembed from the parquet text. Decided	Section numbers and case numbers need exact matching. The dataset lists only dense vectors, so you add this yourself. Hindi needs a Hindi-aware tokenizer (Needs verification)
App database	PostgreSQL	Users, billing, usage limits, chat history. PostgreSQL 16 in Docker, with daily backups to S3
File storage	Amazon S3, Mumbai, encrypted, with auto-delete	Holds uploads and daily database backups. Uploads go straight to S3 with a pre-signed link

Layer	Choice	Why
Documents	Supreme Court judgment text is loaded into PostgreSQL (from the 75 parquet files, read with DuckDB); OCR for user uploads (PyMuPDF for text PDFs, Tesseract for scans, English and Hindi)	Uploads are often scans
Background jobs and cache	Redis with an ARQ job queue. Redis also holds the answer cache	Upload and OCR jobs run in the background, one at a time. The cache keeps verified answers for 7 days (Estimate). Uploads are never cached
Data cleaning	One-time job to turn the Supreme Court's disposition values into a short list. The High Courts' 577 values wait for phase 2	Needed for outcome statistics; a Jev pass with hand checks can do it. Supreme Court first; each High Court waits for its own 50-judgment hand check
LLM	Free plan: Gemini 2.5 Flash-Lite through the LiteLLM gateway, on the paid API tier only (the free API tier may train on data). Student and Pro plans: Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite. A stronger model comes later, for hard questions on Pro. Easy-or-hard routing is switched OFF at launch: every question goes to its plan's default model, and routing turns on once the stronger model is chosen	Biggest lever on cost. One gateway keeps the model swappable
Model source	Hosted API first, with a backup provider that has a no-training rule (provider not yet chosen); test open-weight models later (for example Sarvam 30B, open-sourced in February 2026)	Avoids GPU cost until usage justifies it

Layer	Choice	Why
Decision layer (Jev)	Jev by TypeSafe AI (early access, US servers). Scope check, filters, easy-or-hard routing, answer-or-refuse gate, claim-support check, safety check, upload document typing, and offline disposition cleaning	Returns a typed decision, not free text. 70 to 500 ms per call (Competitor claim). Gemini is the fallback if Jev is down or slower than 800 ms. Jev gets no upload text until written terms are confirmed
Knowledge notes (OKF)	Markdown notes in a knowledge/ folder (IPC to BNS, CrPC to BNSS, Evidence Act to BSA), reviewed before use: legal content by the advocate, coverage rules and terms by the founder	Only reviewed notes reach live answers. A note never counts as a citation by itself
Auth and billing	Firebase Auth (email and Google login; free up to 50,000 monthly users, Checked). Razorpay subscriptions with a webhook	Standard for India, supports UPI. Triggers to move from Firebase to Supabase are in Open questions
Hosting	One AWS EC2 server in Mumbai (r7g.large, 16 GB RAM, 200 GB gp3 disk). Everything runs in Docker Compose	Keeps data in India. About 42 to 55 GB of vectors at launch (Estimate; Supreme Court and acts_india only); the full 440 GB is held but not served. One server, no failover (see Risks). See Fixed infrastructure cost.
Errors and monitoring	Sentry for errors. Langfuse for AI traces and cost per answer	Shows what broke and what each answer cost
Code and deploy	GitHub Actions	Tests and deploys on each change

How one research answer is produced

1. Remember. Load the last 6 turns of this chat in full, plus a running summary of the older turns, and any files the user chose.
2. Rewrite. The question becomes a clean legal search query, and any Act or section it names is noted.
3. Decide (Jev). Is it in scope? Which filters apply? Which model answers (easy-or-hard routing is switched OFF at launch, so every question goes to its plan's default model)? Each Jev call should take under 800 ms. If Jev is down or slower, Gemini takes the decision.

4. Check cache. A verified answer to the same question from the last 7 days (Estimate) is shown at once. Uploads are never cached. A cache hit costs nothing and does not count against the user's limit.
5. Search. The question is embedded with voyage-4 and searched in the launch collection with meaning vectors and BM25 keyword vectors together. It takes the top 50. Questions that name an Act and section, or a case number, use an exact filter instead.
6. Re-rank. Voyage rerank-2.5-lite keeps the best 10 passages.
7. Gate (Jev). Jev scores each of the 10 passages. At most 8 are kept, labelled S1 to S8. If none clears the 0.6 threshold (Needs verification), the answer is "not found" instead of a guess.
8. Answer. Gemini Flash-Lite writes the answer using only those passages and any reviewed knowledge notes, and must cite each passage.
9. Verify. The citation verifier runs four checks (see What Verified means). A citation that does not pass is removed and goes to the invented-citation log. A partly supporting one gets a warning mark.
10. Show. The answer text streams first. The checked citations arrive in one final message after verification, so a citation never appears and then vanishes. Each has a link to the judgment's pdf_url or the Act's source_url, a mark, and the CC BY 4.0 credit.
11. Save. The chat, the usage count and the Langfuse trace are saved. Verified answers go to the cache.

Steps 7 and 9 are what stop hallucinated citations, which is the whole reason to pay for a legal AI. The verifier (step 9) confirms that the cited passage was retrieved for this question, that the record exists, that quoted words appear in it, and that the passage supports the sentence (the Jev check). It cannot confirm that a written citation string is right, because most judgment chunks have none. Do not skip these steps to save cost.

Mobile and bandwidth

Many advocates, especially in district courts, work from a phone on a weak connection. This is the mobile strategy:

1. **Mobile-first web app, installable as a PWA.** No native app in v1. It avoids app-store work and reaches phones from a link.
2. **Text first.** Answers stream as plain text. No heavy images or fonts. Judgments open as text with paragraph anchors; the PDF (pdf_url) opens only on tap, with its file size shown.
3. **Static, fast public pages.** The free Act and statistics pages are server-rendered, so they load and index well on slow networks.
4. **Offline reading.** Saved answers and statistics are cached on the phone.

5. **Resumable uploads** with a size limit shown before upload, so a dropped connection does not lose the file.
6. **Share by link.** Answers and statistics have short links that preview well in WhatsApp.

Needs verification: which phones and networks your target lawyers really use. Ask in the interviews, then set a page-weight and load-time budget and test it on a throttled connection before launch.

Security and privacy

Uploaded documents are confidential client material. Every item below is a launch requirement for anything that accepts uploads.

Area	Requirement
In transit	TLS on every public connection. Containers talk over a private Docker network on one server. Whether internal TLS is also needed is decided with the security tester
At rest	Encrypted disks, databases and uploaded files, with keys in a managed key service
Access control	Each user sees only their own uploads and chats. Team plans give one bill for the team; each member's chats and uploads stay private in v1. No staff access by default; any access needs a logged reason
Audit logging	Log who accessed which record (metadata only, never the document text). The retention period needs a decision with counsel
Retention	Users can delete a chat or an upload at any time, delete their whole account (one job removes everything), and export their data. Deleted data is removed from backups on the next cycle. Consent is recorded with the notice version. The automatic deletion period needs a decision with counsel

Area	Requirement
AI vendors	Use only vendor terms that forbid training on our data. Send only the passages needed, not whole files, where possible. Upload text never goes to Jev. Gemini (paid tier) handles decisions on upload text until TypeSafe confirms its terms in writing. **Needs verification:** each vendor's retention terms and where it processes data
Data leaving India	Questions leave India: they go to Jev (US West Coast servers), to the LLM (Gemini) and to Voyage. Langfuse records prompts and answers, Sentry receives error reports, Firebase holds login data and Razorpay holds payment data. Upload text and user identifiers are masked in Langfuse traces (Needs verification), and Sentry's personal-data scrubbing is on. Jev gets no upload text until written terms are confirmed. Upload text goes only to models with written no-training terms. Needs verification: each vendor's location and retention terms. See the Tech Stack's "Where data goes" table
Breach response	A written playbook. Notify affected users and the Data Protection Board; the DPDP Rules require a detailed report to the Board within 72 hours (EY summary; needs verification against the Rules)
Before public launch	An independent security test, dependency scanning and secrets management. Cost needs verification: get quotes
Keys and updates	Encrypted disks. API keys in AWS Parameter Store or Secrets Manager, never in code. Dependabot for dependency updates. A security test before launch

Go-to-market

Distribution is the biggest unsolved problem. Prism is not a standalone product. It is an upsell on Indian Kanoon, which already has years of traffic among Indian lawyers, and Indian Kanoon says it is used by millions of professionals (its own claim, from a workshop announcement). KanoonBuddy starts with no traffic. The plan is to earn attention with free features that cost almost nothing to serve.

1. Free, no-login, searchable tier. Public pages for Act sections and for outcome statistics ("court, year, issue"), each on its own web address that Google can index. Both use free payload filters, with no Voyage or LLM call, so a page view costs almost nothing. Outcome pages go live only after the audit confirms the outcome field means what we say it does, starting with the Supreme Court, whose half of the hand check can pass first. **Needs verification:** search demand for these pages, using a keyword tool, and what Indian Kanoon and others already show for outcome counts.

2. Shareable outcome statistics. Every statistic gets a permanent link and a share card that shows the source, the data-as-of date and the CC BY credit. Share buttons for WhatsApp and LinkedIn. Cards must be educational and must not name or promote any advocate (see the compliance section).

3. Law school partnerships. Prism is already offered to NLSIU, JGU and Lawctopus (Indian Kanoon's post), so start elsewhere: moot court societies, legal aid clinics and libraries at other law schools. Offer free student access for a semester in return for feedback and a named contact. Cap free usage per student, because each free seat has an LLM cost.

4. The first 100 users (targets, not forecasts).

Group	Target	How, specifically	Owner
Students	40	2 law-school pilots, about 20 students each, run through moot societies or legal aid clinics	You
Advocates	30	The validation interviews double as demos: every advocate interviewed gets free access. The rest come from personal referrals	You, plus an advocate advisor
Public free-tier visitors who sign up	30	Indexed Act and statistics pages, plus shared statistic cards	Whoever owns the web build

If a group is at less than half its target after 6 weeks, change the channel before adding more spend.

5. Channel economics. Revenue a paying user brings, before model, hosting and payment costs, at the proposed prices:

Months as a paying user	Student, ₹199 a month	Pro, ₹499 a month
3	₹597	₹1,497

Months as a paying user	Student, ₹199 a month	Pro, ₹499 a month
6	₹1,194	₹2,994
12	₹2,388	₹5,988

The most you can spend to acquire a paying user (CAC) is the gross profit that user brings before leaving. Gross margin per user **needs verification**: measure cost per answer, Voyage cost per search and hosting on 50 real questions first. Paid-ad CAC also needs verification: run a small test you can afford to lose before committing a budget. Organic channels have almost no cash cost but use your time. Rule of thumb: scale a channel only when its measured CAC is well below the gross profit a user brings before churning; set the exact multiple from real data.

Pricing strategy

The aim is a price students and small chambers can afford, with limits shown up front. These are proposed starting prices to test, not final numbers.

Plan	Proposed price	What it includes	Comparison
Free	₹0	Monthly limits on research chat, upload and chat, and Act lookup. Outcome statistics are added when they pass the 50-judgment Supreme Court check. Answers served from the cache do not count	Prism Free is also ₹0
Student	₹199 a month	Research, study tools, moot court	About 60% below Prism Premium's ₹500 entry price. Far below KanoonGPT's ₹1,299 a month

Plan	Proposed price	What it includes	Comparison
Pro	₹499 a month (₹4,990 a year with 2 months free)	Higher limits, drafting, document review	About equal to Prism Premium (₹500 a month; ₹5,000 for 12 months on my reading). Below LawCentral's ₹1,000 a month Starter. ₹5,988 a year at the monthly price is about a third of SCC Online's ₹18,999 bundle
Chambers	₹299 per user a month, minimum 3 users	One bill for the team; each member's chats and uploads stay private in v1. A shared workspace comes later (month 6 onward).	Below LawCentral's ₹3,500 per seat a month. Prism has organisation support but no public team price

Pricing-page rule. Usage limits are monthly on every plan, including Free. Answers served from the cache do not count against a limit.

Rules for the pricing page:

- Show limits in plain numbers (for example "100 research answers a month") instead of hidden credits.
- Put features that need no embedding in the free tier, such as Act lookup and outcome statistics. They cost almost nothing per query.
- Annual plans give 2 months free.
- A plan must earn a margin after model cost. Check this before you launch, using the cost model below.

Cost check (your own numbers needed)

Margin per user = plan price − (answers per month × cost per answer) − hosting share − payment fees (Razorpay charges a percentage on each payment).

Cost per answer depends on the model you pick and how many passages you send it. Add costs that do not depend on the LLM: a Voyage embed call and a Voyage re-rank call for each meaning-based search (first 200M tokens free for each, Checked; whether that is a one-time grant or monthly is Needs verification), about ₹0.05 per answer for Voyage (50 passages × ~500 tokens × US$0.02 per million; Estimate), about ₹0.03 per answer for Jev (about 8,000 input tokens; Estimate), the 2 to 3 LLM calls per answer (query rewrite, a conversation summary refresh every few turns, and the answer), and the server that runs

Qdrant. Filter-only queries, such as Act lookup and outcome statistics, need no Voyage call. Measure all of it on 50 real questions in week 1 of the build, then set limits so a heavy user still leaves a margin.

Fixed infrastructure cost

The costs above are per query. The largest cost is fixed: keeping the vectors on fast storage all month, whatever the number of users. Needs verification: get quotes from E2E Networks, Yotta and Tata Communications (or another Indian-region provider). The server prices below are E2E's public list prices for Delhi, read from a search excerpt of its pricing page (Competitor claim, not a quote), before tax.

Option	Data to hold	Example server (E2E list price)	Rough monthly cost	Paying users at a blended ₹349 to cover it
Full dataset, all 32.5M vectors	About 440 GB (Measured), plus room for snapshots and refreshes, so 600 to 800 GB of disk	96 GB RAM with 600 GB NVMe (about US$423) up to 128 GB RAM with 800 GB NVMe (about US$564)	About ₹37,000 to ₹50,000 (at ₹88 per US$, Estimate)	About 105 to 145
Launch: Supreme Court and acts_india only	About 42 to 55 GB of vectors (Estimate: (2 to 3M Supreme Court points + 1.1M acts_india points) × about 13.5 KB; the Supreme Court count is not yet measured), about 4 to 5 GB of memory with quantization (Estimate)	AWS EC2 r7g.large in Mumbai: 2 CPUs, 16 GB memory, 200 GB gp3 disk (US$0.0751 an hour; AWS list price quoted in the Tech Stack, Needs verification)	About ₹7,200 to ₹7,500 all-in at launch (Estimate per the Tech Stack, at ₹88 per US$, before GST): server ₹4,820 + disk ₹1,600 (200 GB) + public IP ₹320 + S3 ₹100 + AI ₹200 to ₹500 + Jev ₹100 + Voyage ₹0 + domain ₹100 = ₹7,240 to ₹7,540	About 21 (₹7,350 ÷ ₹349 = 21.1; Estimate)

Option	Data to hold	Example server (E2E list price)	Rough monthly cost	Paying users at a blended ₹349 to cover it
Phase 2: Supreme Court, Bombay, Telangana and Kerala High Courts, acts_india	Launch size plus the High Court points. Count the points per court in Qdrant first (Needs verification). For scale: acts_india alone is about 15 GB (Estimate: 440 GB ÷ 32.5M vectors is about 13.5 KB each, times 1.1M)	32 GB RAM with 200 GB NVMe (about US$141) up to 64 GB RAM with 400 GB NVMe (about US$282)	Illustration only: about ₹12,000 to ₹25,000 (E2E-priced Estimate; not re-priced for AWS)	About 35 to 70

Paying-user counts are the server cost divided by a blended ₹349 (assuming half Student at ₹199 and half Pro at ₹499; I kept the blended figure instead of ₹499), before model, payment and tax costs, so the real number is higher. Needs verification: count the Supreme Court points in Qdrant to confirm 16 GB is enough (the phase 2 size is the launch size plus the High Court points, so it must be bigger than launch), then count the points per court before choosing the phase 2 High Courts, and test how much RAM search needs (the launch plan compresses the vectors with scalar quantization and keeps the full vectors on disk).

Supreme Court plus acts_india is the launch plan, not a fallback. At 3% to 5% of about 400 users, 12 to 20 paying users bring about ₹4,200 to ₹7,000 a month at a blended ₹349 (12 × 349 = 4,188; 20 × 349 = 6,980; assuming half Student at ₹199 and half Pro at ₹499). That does not cover the roughly ₹7,350 launch cost. The cost is covered at about 21 paying users (₹7,350 ÷ ₹349 = 21.1; Estimate). Treat up to about ₹3,300 a month as a launch cost you fund while paying users grow (₹7,500 − ₹4,200 = ₹3,300; Estimate). Add the phase 2 High Courts only when paying users cover the added server cost.

Pricing justification

Willingness to pay. Today the only evidence is competitor prices. No lawyer has been asked. That makes ₹199 and ₹499 hypotheses.

- Students: free tools are the baseline, so a low price has to be paid for by a clear benefit. ₹199 is set below Prism Premium's entry price.
- Advocates: ₹499 is about the same as Prism Premium, so KanoonBuddy must win on Supreme Court depth with verifiable citations, free section-level Act lookup with in-force flags, and visible limits, not on price. Prism and Manupatra already cover parts of this (Competitor claim), so test each point in the interviews.
- Paid tools run from ₹1,000 a month up to ₹30,000 a year and above (competitor claims). ₹499 may be too low for working advocates.

Unit economics. Each plan must pass this check: price after GST and payment fees is greater than answers per month multiplied by cost per answer, plus the Voyage cost per meaning-based search, plus a share of hosting. Free features (Act lookup, statistics) cost almost nothing per query. **Needs verification:** fill in the real numbers from the week 1 cost test, then set the answer limit of each plan so a heavy user still leaves a margin.

Evidence	What it would change
Most interviewed advocates name a price well above ₹499	Raise Pro and add a higher tier
Students will not pay ₹199	Make Student free with a low limit and charge from Pro
Measured cost per answer is more than ₹499 covers at the planned limit	Lower the limit or raise the price
Free-to-paid conversion in the beta is below what break-even needs	Fix the product or the free tier before spending on acquisition
Prism or another tool changes its price	Re-check the comparison column

Indian regulatory compliance

This section states the issues and what to build. It is not legal advice. **Needs verification:** get a written opinion from an advocate before launch; the cost needs verification (get quotes).

Bar Council of India rules

- Rule 36 (Part VI, Chapter II of the BCI Rules) says an advocate shall not solicit work or advertise, directly or indirectly (quoted in the BCI's warning of 18 March 2025, reported by MediaNama). A 2008 amendment lets advocates' own websites carry only basic information: name, qualifications, practice areas and contact details (Bar and Bench).

- The rule binds advocates, not a software vendor. But in the PN Vignesh case the Madras High Court held that platforms which filter or rank lawyers helped unlawful solicitation and asked the BCI to act against both the platforms and the advocates (Bar and Bench).
- **What this means for marketing KanoonBuddy.** Selling a research tool to advocates is fine. Do not list, rank, match or recommend advocates. Do not build a "find a lawyer" feature. Do not publish named advocate testimonials or success stories. Do not pay advocates per client referral. Keep share cards educational and free of advocate names. Whether naming an advocate advisor on the website counts as publicity needs counsel.
- **Legal advice.** KanoonBuddy gives information, not advice. The free tier may be read by non-lawyers, so every answer carries a "not legal advice" notice, and outcome statistics stay descriptive. Whether AI answers to non-lawyers raise any practice-of-law issue needs counsel.

Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 and Rules 2025

- The Rules were notified on 14 November 2025 (Wikipedia, needs verification). Per EY's summary, the Board provisions apply at once, consent-manager rules after 12 months, and data fiduciary obligations after 18 months. Counting 18 months from 14 November 2025 gives about mid-May 2027 (Estimate; Needs verification). Public launch in months 4 to 5 falls before that date, but build to the rules now.
- **Consent and notice:** a clear notice of purpose, the data collected, the retention period and how to withdraw consent.
- **Retention and deletion:** each kind of data has a stated retention period, and users can delete a chat, delete their whole account (one job removes everything), and export their data. Consent is recorded with the notice version. Retention periods are still decided with counsel.
- **Safeguards:** encryption, access control and logs (see Security).
- **Breach notification:** tell the Board and affected users, with a detailed report to the Board within 72 hours (EY summary; needs verification).
- **Our role.** For account data, KanoonBuddy is the data fiduciary. For an advocate's uploaded client documents, the advocate is probably the fiduciary and KanoonBuddy a processor. Needs counsel, and the terms of service must say so.
- **Third parties in uploads.** Uploads name opposing parties and witnesses who never agreed to anything. Needs counsel.
- **Sending data abroad.** Questions leave India: they go to Jev (US West Coast servers), the LLM provider (Gemini) and Voyage. Langfuse (prompts and answers), Sentry (error reports), Firebase (login data) and Razorpay (payment data) also hold data. Jev gets no

upload text until written terms are confirmed. See the Tech Stack's "Where data goes" table. Needs verification of each vendor's location and terms.

- **Public judgments.** The dataset card says victim names and contact details are already removed. Plan our own takedown request process; the card names contact@vaquill.ai for redaction requests.

Privilege

- Section 132 of the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam 2023 covers professional communications between an advocate and client. Reports on a Supreme Court ruling (November 2025) say digital data that reveals legal advice on an advocate's device is protected. I could not open the judgment or the statute text.
- Privilege belongs to the client and advocate, not to KanoonBuddy. But uploading privileged material to a third-party tool might be argued to weaken it. I found no clear authority either way. **Needs verification:** ask counsel before accepting uploads.
- Design for it: no staff access by default, no training on uploads, an optional mode that deletes the upload when the session ends, a warning before upload, and a written policy for how we answer legal orders.

Team, resourcing and timeline

Decision: one solo builder with AI coding agents (see the solo scenario below). The 3-engineer plan is kept for comparison. It is the smallest team that fits the plan:

Role	Does	Time
Tech lead, backend and search	Qdrant retrieval, re-ranking, citation verifier, refresh pipeline	Full time
Full-stack engineer	PWA, login, billing, usage meter, free public pages	Full time
Data and evaluation engineer	Audit, cleaning the 577 outcome values, test set, refresh runs	Full time in weeks 1 to 10, then part time
Designer	Mobile-first screens, share cards	Part time
Advocate advisor	Reviews outputs, definitions and disclaimers	Part time
Support and operations	Support inbox, wrong-answer reports	Part time from beta
Growth owner	Pilots, interviews, first 100 users	You

Monthly cost needs verification: get quotes for salaries or agency rates, plus Voyage, LLM, hosting, legal opinion and security test.

Stress test of weeks 3 to 10. These effort figures are Estimates. **Needs verification:** run a 1-week spike on the research chat pipeline in weeks 1 to 2 and replace them with what you measure.

Item	Estimate (person-weeks)
Research chat pipeline (retrieve, re-rank, prompt, streaming UI)	4
Act and section lookup	2
Citation verifier	2
Usage meter	1.5
Login and Razorpay billing	3
Source credit and data-as-of display	1
First pass of the data refresh pipeline	3
Test set and evaluation harness	2
Jev decision layer	Not estimated
Knowledge notes	Not estimated
Upload and OCR	Not estimated
Answer cache	Not estimated
Invented-citation log	Not estimated
Admin page	Not estimated
Account deletion and export	Not estimated
Chambers accounts	Not estimated
Total	**18.5**

Eight weeks (weeks 3 to 10) of 3 full-time engineers is 24 person-weeks against the 18.5 estimated, leaving about 5.5 for design, bug fixing and security work, so the plan fits only with 3 engineers and little slack. With 2 engineers it takes about 9 weeks; with 1, about 18 or more. The roadmap now allots weeks 3 to 10, and any smaller team needs more.

Solo scenario (decision 2, Needs verification). One builder with AI coding agents has the same 18.5 person-weeks to build, so by the arithmetic above it takes about 18 weeks or more before any speed-up from the agents. The 18.5 figure leaves out Jev, the OKF knowledge notes, upload and OCR, the answer cache, the invented-citation log and the admin page, so the real number is higher. Do not promise a date. Time build steps 1 and 2, then re-plan. Success-metric owners are the founder while the build is solo.

Risks

The biggest risks are data quality and the Voyage dependency. Data rights are largely covered by the CC BY 4.0 licence.

Risk	Why it matters	What to do
No distribution	Prism sits on Indian Kanoon's existing traffic. KanoonBuddy has none.	See Go-to-market: free indexed pages, shareable statistics, law school pilots
Outcome field may mislead	Supreme Court dispositions are concentrated in about ten values that read as final outcomes (Appeal(s) allowed 13,913, Dismissed 13,800, Disposed off 4,724, Case Partly allowed 1,825, Case Allowed 733, out of 37,014 cases; Measured, 6 October 2026), so Supreme Court statistics can ship on a shorter check. For the High Courts the field may still describe an interlocutory order rather than the final result (Needs verification).	Hand-check 100 judgments in weeks 1 to 2: 50 Supreme Court and 50 High Court, with the pass rule agreed first. The Supreme Court half can unblock Supreme Court statistics on its own. Do not launch High Court statistics until their half passes
Data quality	Citations are filled on 100.0% of Supreme Court chunks but 0.0% of High Court chunks (Measured, 6 October 2026). Judges are filled for 32.7% and the sampled values were garbage. Party names are often counsel names or fragments (all measured). A tool sold on trust cannot show wrong names.	Fill rates are now measured. In weeks 1 to 2, run the garbage check on judges and party names for the launch courts. Do not display any field that fails the audit

Risk	Why it matters	What to do
Voyage lock-in	Meaning-based search only works with voyage-4 query embeddings. A price rise or outage hits every such search, and changing model means re-embedding the launch collection, a far smaller set than 32.5M (count it in build step 1; Needs verification).	Get the per-query cost in week 1. Cache repeated questions. Keep the embedding call behind one function. Filter-only features are unaffected
Text without vectors	Either about 1,153,189 judgment chunks (3.5%) or only about 55,000 (0.2%) may exist as text with no vector, depending on whether the 32,572,660 total includes the 1,098,269 legislation rows (Needs verification: count rows per judgment file versus points per collection)	Reconcile the counts in the audit, then embed the gap or leave those courts out
Dependence on Vaquill	One organisation publishes the whole dataset	See the section on Vaquill below
Regulatory exposure	Bar Council advertising rules, the DPDP Act and privilege all touch the product	See Indian regulatory compliance. Get an advocate's written opinion before launch
Team too small for the schedule	The plan needs about 18.5 person-weeks in weeks 3 to 10 (Estimate; a solo build is longer, Needs verification)	See Team, resourcing and timeline. Solo builder with AI coding agents. Longer than weeks 3 to 10 (Needs verification after build steps 1 and 2)
No tribunal data	Our copy has no tribunal files (Measured). 813,168 tribunal and regulator matters across 15 forums are published free at tribunals.vaquill.ai under CC BY 4.0, PDF-only with no text layer, about 348,516 of them reasoned decisions (Competitor claim: Vaquill's pages and estimate).	The blocker is OCR and extraction effort, not money, so tribunals are a credible post-launch expansion rather than a dead end. Do not advertise tribunals at launch

Risk	Why it matters	What to do
Partial, frozen data	Fewer documents than the largest legal databases, no district courts, and nothing after the v2026.08 snapshot	Show a data-as-of date on every result. The refresh plan is in the roadmap
Messy outcome labels	The 577-value problem belongs to the High Courts (Measured, 6 October 2026): the disposition field has 577 different values for a handful of real outcomes, so raw High Court counts would mislead. The Supreme Court does not have this problem.	Clean the High Court values into a short list once, then spot-check by hand before showing any High Court statistic
Infrastructure size	About 440 GB of vectors, too big to run well on a laptop in production. Adding courts back (phase 2) is gated on paying users	Launch with the Supreme Court and acts_india on one 16 GB server (about 42 to 55 GB of vectors, Estimate). Phase 2 adds Bombay, Telangana and Kerala when paying users cover the cost
Jev dependency	Jev is early access (released 15 September 2026) and runs on US West Coast servers. Its no-training terms are not confirmed. It makes the scope, gate and claim-support decisions, so an outage or a bad decision touches every answer.	Apply for access and ask for written data terms in weeks 1 to 2. Gemini takes the decision if Jev is down or slower than 800 ms. Send Jev no upload text until the terms are confirmed. Needs verification
One server, no failover	One EC2 server runs the website, API, database, Qdrant and Redis. If it fails, everything stops. The 99.5% availability target allows about 3.6 hours of downtime a month.	EC2 auto recovery, daily snapshots to S3 and a rebuild target under 1 hour (Estimate). Add a second server only when paying users justify the cost

Risk	Why it matters	What to do
Memory pressure on a 16 GB server	Qdrant search memory and OCR time are the two things that break first. Search, OCR and the database share one box. The vectors need about 4 to 5 GB of memory with quantization (Estimate), on a 16 GB server.	Scalar quantization. One OCR job at a time, capped at 1 CPU. Count the Supreme Court points in build step 1 and move to a larger server if the count needs it (Needs verification)
LLM vendor data terms	Questions go to Gemini, Voyage and Jev, all outside India. The free Gemini API tier may train on data.	Use the Gemini paid tier only. Get written no-training and retention terms from each vendor before launch. Needs verification
Licence and credit	CC BY 4.0 requires credit. The dataset card says the terms come from the source institutions.	Show credit on every result. Get a lawyer to confirm commercial use for your plans
Hallucinated citations	One fake case in a court filing can hurt a lawyer badly	The verifier is P0. Show the badge only when the check passes, and use the wording defined in "What Verified means"
Competitors	Prism has Indian Kanoon's traffic. SCC Online and Manupatra have editorial content and long-standing customers. Several AI entrants exist. The 6 October 2026 hands-on test (one run per prompt; Competitor claim, single-sample evidence) shows Prism's actual answers, not just Indian Kanoon's traffic, are a proven accuracy bar to beat. Manupatra already has in-force flags, which narrows differentiator #2 to free, section-level and zero marginal cost. KanoonGPT now answers case law, unreliably, rather than deferring it	Compete on Supreme Court depth with verifiable citations (checked per citation), free section-level Act lookup with in-force flags (not unique: Manupatra has a paid version), Hindi, team workspace and visible limits. Treat Prism's answer quality as the accuracy bar and test our verifier against it

Risk	Why it matters	What to do
Model cost eats margin	Usage-based cost rises with heavy users	Model router, monthly limits, caching repeat questions
Legal advice liability	Outcome prediction can be read as advice	Clear disclaimers. Prefer descriptive statistics over prediction
Client confidentiality	Lawyers will not upload case files to an unknown tool	Indian hosting, no training on user data, clear privacy page. See Security
Name and branding	"KanoonBuddy" sounds close to Indian Kanoon and to the existing KanoonGPT. That could cause confusion or a trademark claim.	Run a trademark search before launch. See the naming section for 5 alternatives

Dependence on Vaquill

The whole product rests on one organisation continuing to publish this dataset. This is what happens if that changes.

If Vaquill	What happens	What we do
Stops publishing	The v2026.08 snapshot we already hold stays usable. No new judgments arrive from them	Run the project's scrapers ourselves (the code is Apache-2.0) or go to the court websites directly. The refresh plan budgets for this
Changes the licence for new releases	The new terms apply only to new releases. CC BY 4.0 cannot be withdrawn for a copy already received (the general rule for Creative Commons licences; a lawyer must confirm)	Keep the licence text and dataset card as downloaded, with the date and file checksums. Keep an offline copy of the data and the scraper code
Starts charging	Same as above: new data may cost money, the existing snapshot is unaffected	Ask now what the bulk extraction service costs (contact@vaquill.ai, per the dataset card) and keep a contingency line in the budget

If Vaquill	What happens	What we do
Builds a competing product	Vaquill already sells an end-user legal AI product (Competitor claim). Its India focus today is legislation and data, not Indian case-law research, which is where we compete, but it holds the same corpus and the capability	Compete on product, distribution and trust, not on data. **Needs verification:** whether it plans an Indian case-law product

Do this now: email Vaquill to confirm in writing that commercial use is fine, how often they plan to publish new snapshots, and what bulk extraction costs.

Success metrics, validation and roadmap

KanoonBuddy succeeds if lawyers trust its citations and pay for it. Targets below are starting guesses to adjust once you have real usage.

Metric	Starting target (a guess, needs verification after the beta)	Definition	How it is measured	Who
Verified-citation rate	98% or higher	Share of authorities cited in answers that pass the verifier	Automatic run over the fixed 200-question test set below, on every release	Founder
Answer correctness	Set from the first baseline	Each answer graded correct, partly correct or wrong	Two advocates grade each answer blind, and a third settles disagreements	Founder (two advocates grade each answer blind; a third settles disagreements)

Metric	Starting target (a guess, needs verification after the beta)	Definition	How it is measured	Who
Verifier accuracy	Set from the first baseline	Of authorities shown as verified, the share a human confirms exist with a matching quote. This is separate from correctness	A random sample of answers checked by hand; the sample size is agreed with the advisor	Founder
Free to paid conversion	3% to 5%	Paying accounts divided by free sign-ups, counted 30 days after sign-up	Billing database	Founder
Answers users mark helpful	80% or higher	Thumbs-up divided by rated answers, plus a count of wrong-answer reports	In-app rating button	Founder
Gross margin per paid user	60% or higher	(Revenue minus LLM, Voyage and payment fees) divided by revenue, per month. Fixed hosting is excluded and tracked separately as a monthly burn figure (see Fixed infrastructure cost)	Invoices and usage logs	Founder

Metric	Starting target (a guess, needs verification after the beta)	Definition	How it is measured	Who
Monthly active users	400 at 3 months after public launch	Accounts with at least one answer in 30 days	Event log that never stores document text	Founder
Invented-citation rate	Under 0.5% of answers (Estimate)	Share of answers with at least one removed citation, for any of the four failure reasons: not retrieved, record missing, quote not found, claim not supported	The invented-citation log, reviewed on every release	Founder

Monthly active users: The target is lowered from 2,000 to 400, because the channels in Go-to-market cannot plausibly produce 2,000. Assumed path from 100 to 400 (Needs verification; every input is an Estimate, to be replaced with pilot data): the first 100 users (40 students, 30 advocates, 30 free-page sign-ups), plus 160 more students if the pilots grow to 4 law schools of about 50 active students each, plus 30 advocates if each of the 30 refers one, plus about 90 from free pages (about 3,000 visits a month, 2% sign up, half of them ask a question within 30 days, over 3 months: 3,000 × 2% × 3 = 180, half is 90). That adds to about 380, rounded to 400. If pilots and search traffic come in at half the assumption, the total is about 240. Reaching 2,000 would need a new channel with an owner and a cost; none is planned. This counts every sign-up as still active, which no product achieves. At 60% month-on-month active retention the same inputs give about 250 (Needs verification). Set the real number after the beta, from measured retention.

The 200-question test set. 100 real questions collected in the validation interviews, 50 Act and section lookups, and 50 traps (cases that do not exist, wrong section numbers, events after the snapshot date). This mix is a proposal (Estimate). The advocate advisor signs it off before it is used, and it is frozen so results can be compared release to release.

Retention and support

Retention. Track week-4 retention of free users, month-3 retention of paying users and monthly churn. Set the targets after the beta from the break-even in the channel economics table: paying users must stay long enough for their gross profit to cover the cost of acquiring them. I have not set a number because none has been measured.

Support model (proposed).

Channel	Who staffs it	First response
Support email and an in-app help form	Part-time support and operations person	Within 1 business day for free users, same business day for paid users during the beta
"Report a wrong answer" button on every answer	Advocate advisor triages legal-accuracy reports	Within 2 business days
Optional WhatsApp number for paid users	Same support person	Decide after the interviews show whether advocates ask for it

Staffing cost needs verification: get quotes.

User validation plan

This PRD is entirely assumption-based, and no lawyer has been interviewed. Before any code beyond the audit spike, run about 20 interviews of 30 to 45 minutes each: 8 district court advocates, 6 High Court advocates and 6 law students. Recruit through your own contacts, the law-school pilots, bar association introductions and LinkedIn. Every person interviewed gets free access as thanks. The interview counts and durations are my proposal.

Assumption	How it is tested	A result that would change the roadmap
Advocates trust an answer with a "record found" badge	Show 10 sample answers and ask what they would still check	If most still re-check every citation elsewhere, the badge will not sell the product. Invest in one-click source viewing instead

Assumption	How it is tested	A result that would change the roadmap
Outcome statistics are wanted	Show a mock statistics page and ask what decision it would inform	If few would use it, drop it from the headline features and the free-tier wedge
₹199 and ₹499 are right	Ask price questions at several price points	Follow the evidence table in Pricing justification
Lawyers work from phones	Ask which device and network they use, and watch one real research session	If most use desktops, cut the mobile budget
Hindi is needed	Ask which language they research in	If strongly needed, move Hindi from P1 to P0
Statute lookup, Supreme Court precedent and drafting are enough for district-court advocates	Ask: is that enough for district-court advocates? Watch one real research session	If not, move the High Court phase 2 earlier, or stop treating district-court advocates as a launch target
Advocates will upload client documents	Ask how they feel about privilege and confidentiality	If few would, revisit the upload limits and the warning wording
Free tools such as Indian Kanoon are enough	Ask what they use now and what frustrates them	If they are satisfied, focus on students first

Roadmap

1. Weeks 1 to 2, audit and validation: the fill-rate audit of all 75 files is done (Measured, 6 October 2026); what remains is a garbage check of judges and party names for the launch courts. Hand-check 100 judgments against their disposition value to see whether it describes the case outcome or an interlocutory order: 50 Supreme Court and 50 High Court, where the Supreme Court half can unblock Supreme Court statistics on its own. Reconcile the chunk gap (32,572,660 chunks in parquet against 31,419,471 judgment vectors in Qdrant: if the total includes the 1,098,269 legislation rows, the gap is about 55,000, or 0.2%; if not, it is about 1,153,189, or 3.5%; count rows per judgment file versus points per collection) and the three judgment counts in circulation (12.8M+, 32.5M, 15,693,540). Get the Voyage cost per search and test 3 LLM options on 50 real questions. Run the 1-week pipeline spike. Confirm every Docker image has an ARM build, because the r7g server uses ARM chips. Apply for Jev early access and email TypeSafe for written data terms. Count the Supreme Court points in Qdrant and build the launch collection (Supreme Court and acts_india). Evaluate

upgrading to snapshot v2026.08.1, which fills source_url on 83.3% of rows against our current 0.0% (Competitor claim for the new release, Measured for ours); judgment attribution currently relies on pdf_url alone. Weigh the download cost against the measured mirror speeds (0.03 to 11.6 MB/s) in the Data refresh plan. Request per-file checksums from Vaquill, since only 1 of our 75 files can be integrity-checked (Measured). Start the 20 interviews. Email Vaquill with three questions: (a) does the India API licence permit caching responses and serving them to our end users, including on public search-indexed pages? (b) what does bulk or daily-sync data licensing cost for the India judgment corpus, and does it include incremental deltas? This is our refresh plan's cheapest possible answer. (c) is a judgments endpoint on the India roadmap? Ask an advocate for a quote for the legal opinion.

2. Weeks 3 to 10 in the 3-engineer plan, and longer for the solo builder with AI coding agents (Needs verification, see Team): research chat, Act and section lookup, citation verifier with the Jev claim-support check, the Jev decision layer, OKF knowledge notes (legal content reviewed by an advocate; coverage rules, terms and labels by the founder), the Redis answer cache and invented-citation log, usage meter, login and billing, source credit, the first data refresh pipeline, and the cleaned outcome labels. Upload and chat is built in this phase and ships in v1.
3. Weeks 11 to 14: free public pages, and outcome statistics only if the audit passed. Upload and chat, which ships in v1, is part of the private beta. Private beta with 20 law students and 10 advocates.
4. Before public launch: the first data refresh is done and checked, the advocate's written opinion is in hand, Voyage's written no-training and retention terms are in hand, and the independent security test has passed.
5. Months 4 to 5: drafting, document review, Hindi support, public launch with a data-as-of date on every result.
6. Month 6 onward: quarterly refreshes, counter arguments, moot court, team workspace.

Launch gate

Public launch (months 4 to 5) happens only if ALL of these are true at the end of the private beta (weeks 11 to 14):

- Verified-citation rate on the 200-question test set is 98% or higher (the target in Success metrics; Needs verification after the first baseline).
- At least 6 of the 10 beta advocates say they would pay the proposed Pro price (60% is my proposed threshold; Needs verification against the interview results).
- Zero confirmed incidents of a fabricated citation reaching a beta user, and fewer than 0.5% of test-set answers have a removed citation (Estimate; see Success metrics).
- The advocate's written legal opinion has been received.

- Voyage's written no-training and retention terms have been received.
- The independent security test has passed.
- The first data refresh is complete and reconciled.

If any condition fails, the launch date moves. Akshita Johari decides, as founder.

Data refresh plan

Why it matters. The snapshot is v2026.08 and public launch is in months 4 to 5, so KanoonBuddy would ship with law up to about 8 months old (Estimate). Lawyers will notice a missing recent judgment.

Item	Plan
Owner	The founder runs it and is accountable
Cadence	Quarterly, with the first refresh finished before public launch. Decide later whether the Supreme Court needs monthly updates
Cost	Needs verification. Three parts: Voyage cost to embed the new chunks (number of chunks times tokens per chunk times Voyage's price), compute for scraping and parsing, and engineer time. Time the first run to get the real figures
Acceptance test	Row counts reconcile, a hand-checked sample of new judgments looks right, and the data-as-of date is updated per court

Technical approach: refresh incrementally, do not re-download the snapshot.

1. Run the project's scrapers (Apache-2.0) from an Indian IP for each court, for dates after the snapshot. **Needs verification:** which scrapers still work, since government sites change.
2. Parse the results into the same schema as the snapshot.
3. Cut them into chunks and embed the new chunks with voyage-4, which must match the existing vectors.
4. Add the new points to Qdrant. Store each court's data-as-of date in a coverage table and show it on every result. Clear the answer cache after each refresh.
5. Reconcile counts, re-run the audit sample, and publish a short change log.

Why not a full re-download. The mirror is slow and erratic: measured speeds were between 0.03 and 11.6 MB/s over 24 hours. The dataset card gives the snapshot as 53.6 GB of text plus 463.6 GB of vectors, about 517 GB. At the best measured speed that is about 12 hours of continuous transfer; at the worst it is about 200 days. So every full refresh would be a multi-day operation at best, which is why the plan is incremental.

Naming

"KanoonBuddy" is a placeholder pending the naming decision, not the final name. It uses Indian Kanoon's brand word, and KanoonGPT already exists, so here are 5 alternatives. None is derived from a competitor's name, and each is short and easy to say in Hindi and English.

Name	Meaning	Why it fits	Watch-outs
Praman (प्रमाण)	Proof, evidence	Matches the promise of checked citations	A common Hindi word, so crowded
Nirnay (निर्णय)	Judgment, decision	Fits judgments and outcome statistics	May already be used by others
Dhara (धारा)	A section of a law	Fits Act and section lookup	Also means "stream"; very common
Sandarbh (संदर्भ)	Reference, citation	Fits citations	Harder for English speakers to say
Nazeer (नज़ीर)	Precedent	Fits case law	Also a common personal name

Recommendation: Praman. It is the shortest, easy to say in both languages, and it states the product's core promise, which is proof behind every citation. **Needs verification for every name:** a trademark search with IP India for software classes, the domain, the app stores and social handles. I have not checked any of them.

Naming note. Internal names such as the collection kanoon_v1 and the folder kanoonbuddy/ are placeholders, like the product name. Decided: the collection name and the product name each live in one config value, so renaming is a config change. Prefer neutral internal names (for example research_v1) in anything new.

Top 5 open questions before any code is written

Ranked by how much the answer would change the plan. None of these is answered by the dataset; each needs a person, a hand check or a lawyer.

1. **Will advocates and students pay, and how much?** Needs 20 interviews (see the user validation plan). If the answer is "not at these prices", the pricing and the whole go-to-market section change.
2. **Does `disposition` describe the final outcome or an interlocutory order?** Needs the 100-judgment hand check (50 Supreme Court, 50 High Court) in the Week 1–2 audit. The Supreme Court half can clear Supreme Court statistics on its own; if the High Court half shows a mix, High Court statistics cannot ship.
3. **How do the first 100 users find us?** Needs a yes or no from at least two law schools on a pilot, and a test of whether free indexed pages get any search traffic. Without distribution, the product does not matter.
4. **Who builds it, and what is the budget?** Decided: one solo builder with AI coding agents. The weeks 3–10 schedule fits only the 3-engineer plan, so the solo timeline is longer. Time build steps 1 and 2 (data, then the pipeline notebook), then re-plan. Needs verification.
5. **What do counsel and Vaquill say?** Two conversations: a lawyer on privilege, the DPDP role and the line to legal advice; and Vaquill on three questions. (a) Does the India API licence permit caching responses and serving them to end users, including on public indexed pages? This now matters only for the optional API upgrade, since our own data already supports section lookup. (b) What does bulk or daily-sync licensing cost for the India judgment corpus, does it include incremental deltas, and which judgment count is right (12.8M+, 32.5M or 15,693,540)? This could replace the whole Data refresh plan. (c) Is a judgments endpoint on the India roadmap? This changes the 12-month architecture but not the next 8 weeks. Either conversation can force a scope change.

Other open questions

- Voyage per-query cost and monthly budget. List prices are Checked (US$0.06 per million tokens to embed, US$0.02 to re-rank, first 200M free each); the cost per query on real questions is Needs verification (build step 2).
- Is the chunk gap about 55,000 or about 1.15M? Needs the Week 1–2 count in parquet versus Qdrant.
- Refresh method for the snapshot: full re-download or delta? Needs a test against the mirror.
- Hindi-first or English-first for the interface and answers?
- Trademark search on the final name (and on the 5 alternatives) before any branding spend.
- Monthly LLM budget per paying user: needs measuring on the 200-question test set.
- Whether to extract tribunal data after launch, since none is in the dataset: the PDFs are free under CC BY 4.0 but have no text layer, so the cost is OCR and engineering effort, not licensing.

- Who cleans the High Courts' 577 disposition values, and to what standard? Phase 2; not needed at launch.
- Jev access and terms: will TypeSafe grant early access, and will it confirm in writing that it does not train on our data and where it processes it? Needs an application and an email in weeks 1 to 2. Gemini is the fallback.
- Supreme Court point count and server size: how many vectors does the Supreme Court plus acts_india need, and does it fit on an r7g.large (16 GB)? Needs the count in build step 1 (Needs verification).
- Firebase or Supabase: stay on Firebase Auth until a trigger is hit (more than 50,000 monthly users, SAML or SSO for a firm, or a need for database-level access rules). Needs a decision at each trigger.

Sources

The GitHub page and dataset card were opened in full. The counts and fill rates in Data foundation come from the DuckDB audit of all 75 files on 6 October 2026 (see What the audit found).

- open-india-law, GitHub (Vaquill AI)
- open-india-law dataset card, Hugging Face
- Sarvam AI, Wikipedia

Competitor and Prism sources

- Prism pricing page: https://indiankanoon.org/prism/pricing/ (opened; the prices in the teardown come from here)
- Prism home page, premium page, blog, and the JGU trial, workshop and guide pages (Prism's own pages)
- Indian Kanoon post on X announcing Prism
- Third-party competitor prices: Bharat.Law, CaseMine blog, LawCentral comparison page, KanoonGPT site (competitor claims, needs verification)
- Market context: eCourts India startups blog and an iPleaders guide to legal-tech tools

Competitive-analysis sources, 6 Oct 2026 update

- Hands-on 10-prompt test of Prism AI, LawCentral AI, KanoonGPT, CaseMine AMICUS and "BharatLaw" (NyaI), one run per prompt (Competitor claim, single-sample evidence; Needs verification before public use). "BharatLaw" here is likely a different company from the Bharat.Law in the competitor table.
- Desk-research scorecard covering 9 platforms (Competitor claim; Needs verification before public use)

Regulation sources

- MediaNama and Bar and Bench coverage of BCI Rule 36 and the PN Vignesh case
- EY note and Wikipedia entry on the DPDP Rules notified 14 Nov 2025
- KS&K note on Section 132 of the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam 2023 (privilege)

Some competitor pages were read only as search excerpts, not opened in full. Treat every competitor price as needs verification until checked on the vendor's own page. Regulation notes are secondary summaries, not legal advice; confirm with counsel.